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Topics covered

- Evolution processes
- Legacy systems
- Software maintenance

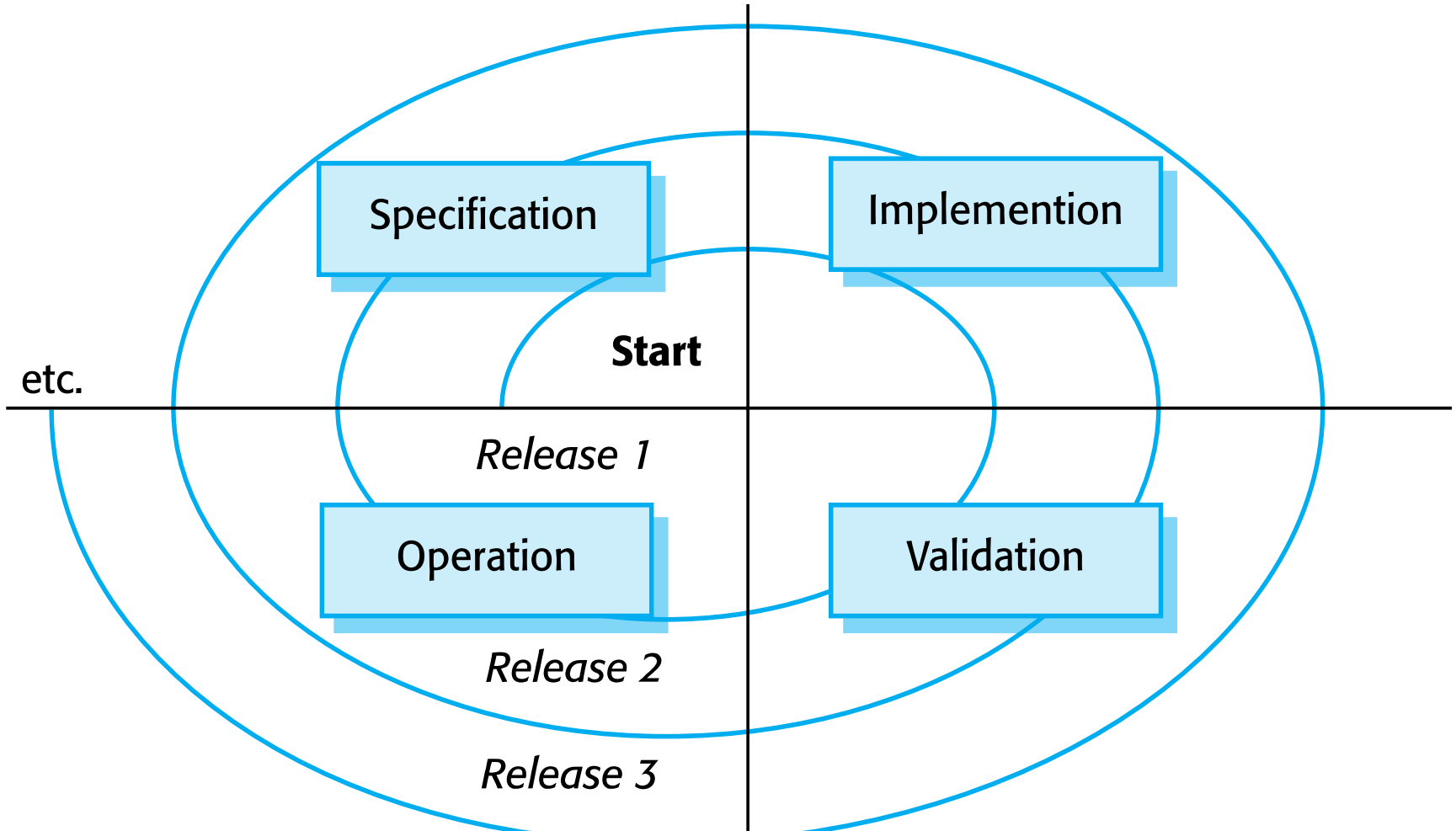
Software change

- Software change is inevitable
 - **New requirements** emerge when the software is used;
 - The **business environment changes**;
 - **Errors** must be repaired;
 - **New computers and equipment** is added to the system;
 - The **performance** or **reliability** of the system may have to be **improved**.
- A key problem for all organizations is **implementing and managing change** to their **existing software systems**.

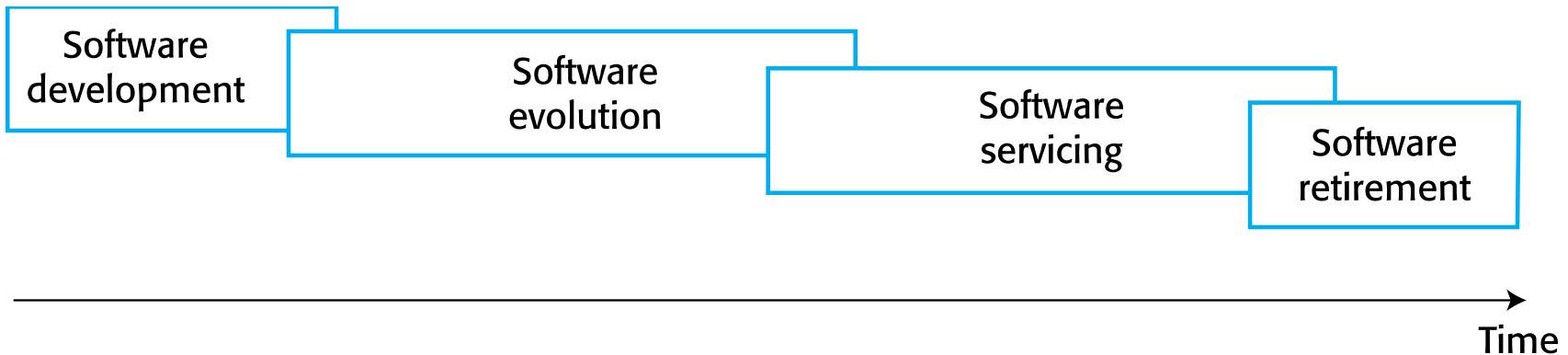
Importance of evolution

- Organizations have **huge investments** in their software systems - they are **critical business assets**.
- To **maintain the value** of these assets to the business, they must be **changed** and **updated**.
- The majority of the **software budget** in large companies is **devoted to changing and evolving existing software** rather than developing new software.

A spiral model of development and evolution



Evolution and servicing



Evolution and servicing

■ Evolution

- The stage in a software system's life cycle where it is in operational use and is evolving as **new requirements are proposed and implemented** in the system.

■ Servicing

- At this stage, the software remains useful but the only **changes** made are those **required to keep it operational** i.e. bug fixes and changes to reflect changes in the software's environment. **No new functionality** is added.

■ Phase-out

- The software may still be used but **no further changes** are made to it.

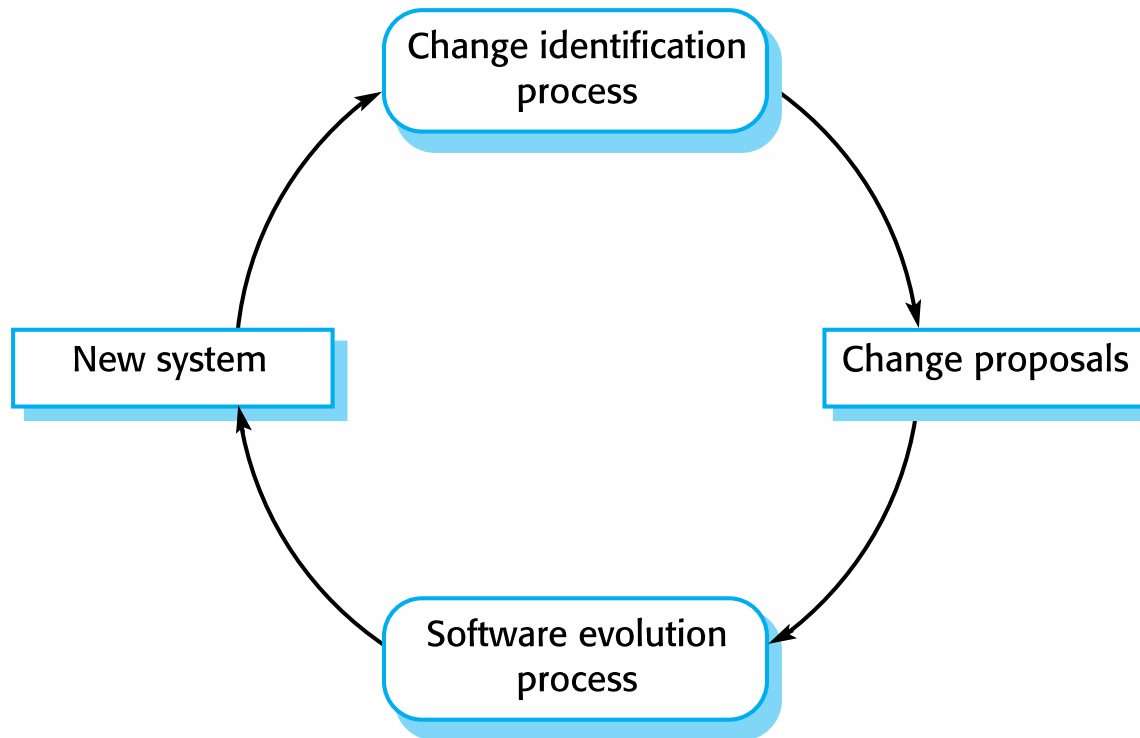


Evolution processes

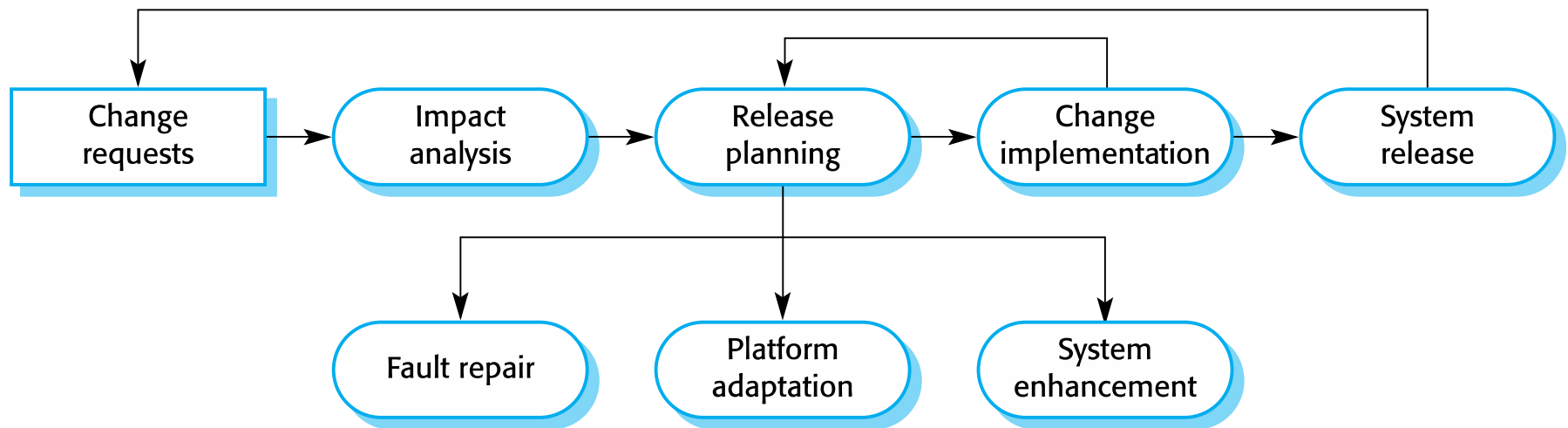
Evolution processes

- Software evolution processes depend on
 - The **type** of software being maintained;
 - The **development processes** used;
 - The **skills** and **experience** of the people involved.
- Proposals for change are the driver for system evolution.
 - Should be linked with **components** that are **affected by the change**, thus allowing the **cost** and **impact** of the change to be **estimated**.
- Change identification and evolution **continues** throughout the system **lifetime**.

Change identification and evolution processes



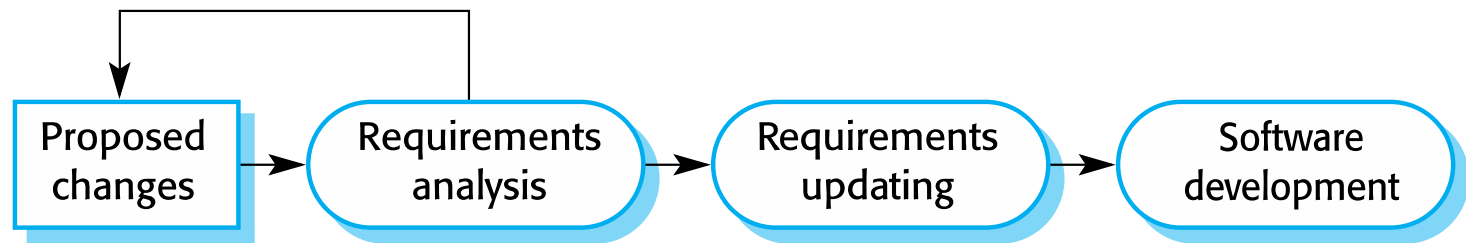
The software evolution process



Change implementation

- **Iteration** of the development process where the **revisions** to the system are **designed, implemented and tested**.
- A critical difference is that the **first stage** of change implementation may involve **program understanding**, especially if the original system developers are not responsible for the change implementation.
- During the program understanding phase, you have to understand **how** the **program is structured**, how it **delivers functionality** and how the **proposed change** might **affect** the program.

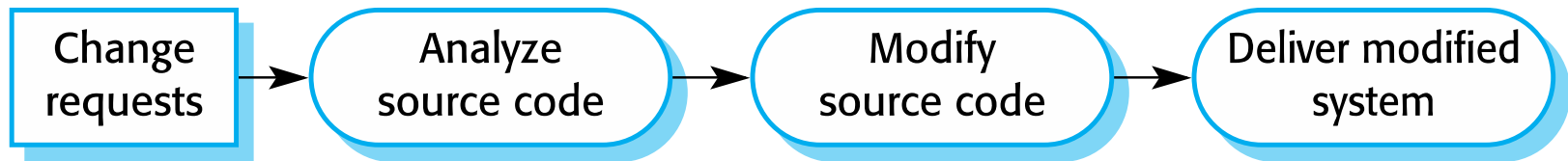
Change implementation



Urgent change requests

- Urgent changes may have to be implemented without going through all stages of the software engineering process
 - If a **serious system fault** has to be repaired to allow normal operation to continue;
 - If changes to the **system's environment** (e.g. an OS upgrade) have **unexpected effects**;
 - If there are **business changes** that require a very **rapid response** (e.g. the release of a competing product).

The emergency repair process



Agile methods and evolution

- Agile methods are based on incremental development so the transition from development to evolution is a seamless one.
 - Evolution is simply a **continuation** of the development process based on **frequent system releases**.
- **Automated regression testing** is particularly valuable when changes are made to a system.
- Changes may be expressed as **additional user stories**.

Handover problems (1)

- Where the **development team** have used an **agile approach** but the **evolution team** is **unfamiliar** with agile methods and prefer a plan-based approach.
 - The evolution team may expect **detailed documentation to support evolution** and this is **not produced** in agile processes.

Handover problems (2)

- Where a **plan-based approach** has been used for development but the **evolution team** prefer to use **agile methods**.
 - The evolution team may have to **start from scratch** developing automated tests and the code in the system **may not have been refactored and simplified** as is expected in agile development.

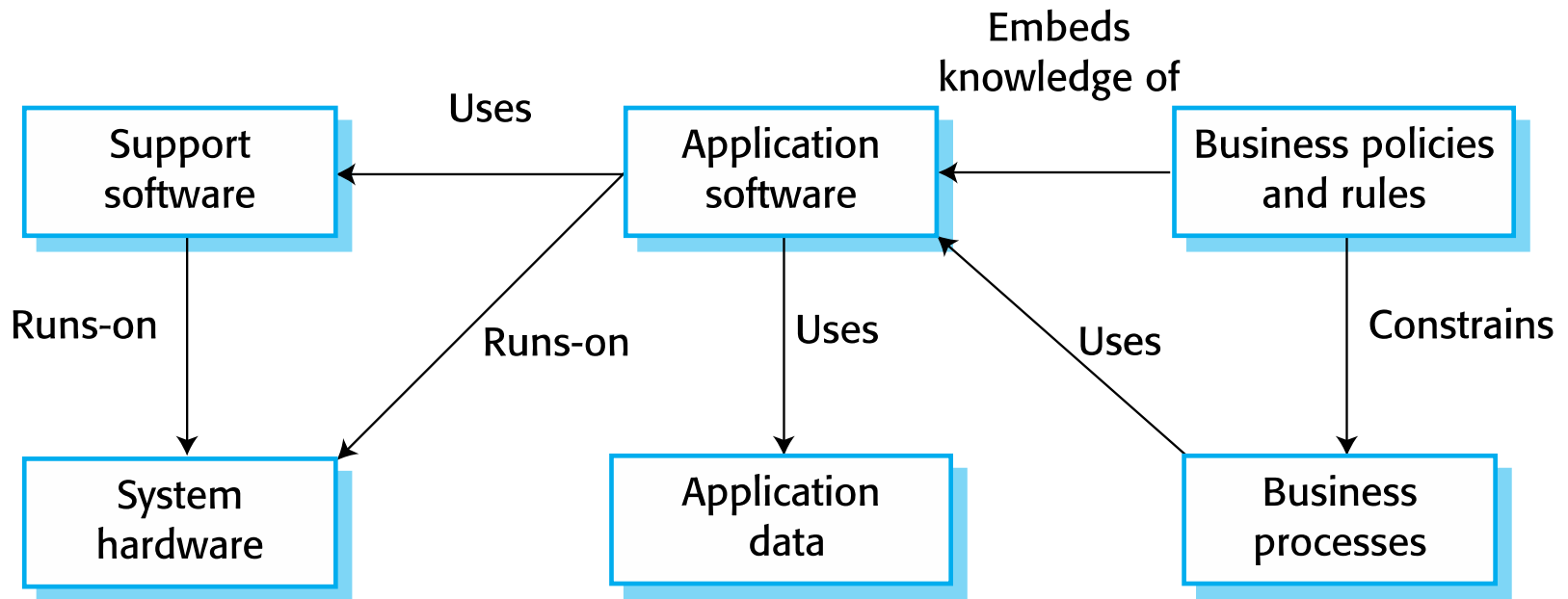


Legacy systems

Legacy systems

- Legacy systems are older systems that rely on languages and technology that are **no longer used** for new systems development.
- Legacy software may be dependent on **older hardware**, such as mainframe computers and may have associated **legacy processes and procedures**.
- Legacy systems are not just software systems but are **broader socio-technical systems** that include hardware, software, libraries and other supporting software and business processes.

The elements of a legacy system



Legacy system components (1)

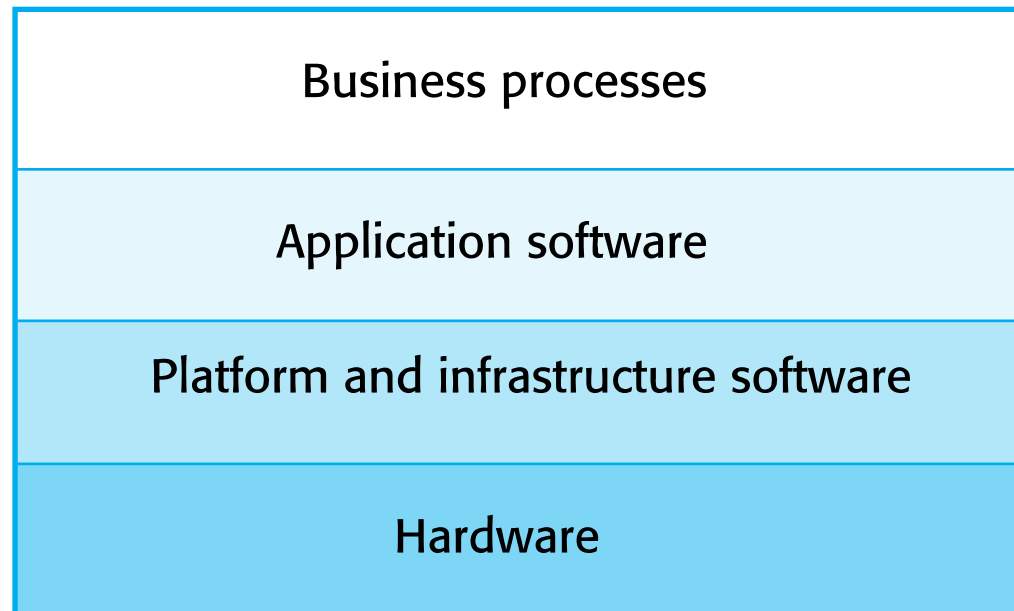
- *System hardware* Legacy systems may have been written for **hardware** that is **no longer available**.
- *Support software* The legacy system may rely on a range of **support software**, which may be **obsolete or unsupported**.
- *Application software* The application system that provides the business services is usually made up of a **number of application programs**.
- *Application data* These are data that are processed by the application system. They may be **inconsistent, duplicated** or held in **different databases**.

Legacy system components (2)

- *Business processes* These are processes that are used in the business to achieve some **business objective**.
- Business processes may be **designed** around a legacy system and **constrained** by the functionality that it provides.
- *Business policies and rules* These are definitions of **how** the business should be **carried out** and **constraints** on the business. Use of the legacy application system may be embedded in these policies and rules.

Legacy system layers

Socio-technical system



Legacy system replacement

- Legacy system **replacement** is **risky** and **expensive** so businesses continue to use these systems
- System replacement is **risky** for a number of reasons
 - **Lack** of complete system **specification**
 - Tight **integration** of **system** and **business processes**
 - **Undocumented** business rules embedded in the legacy system
 - New software development may be **late** and/or **over budget**

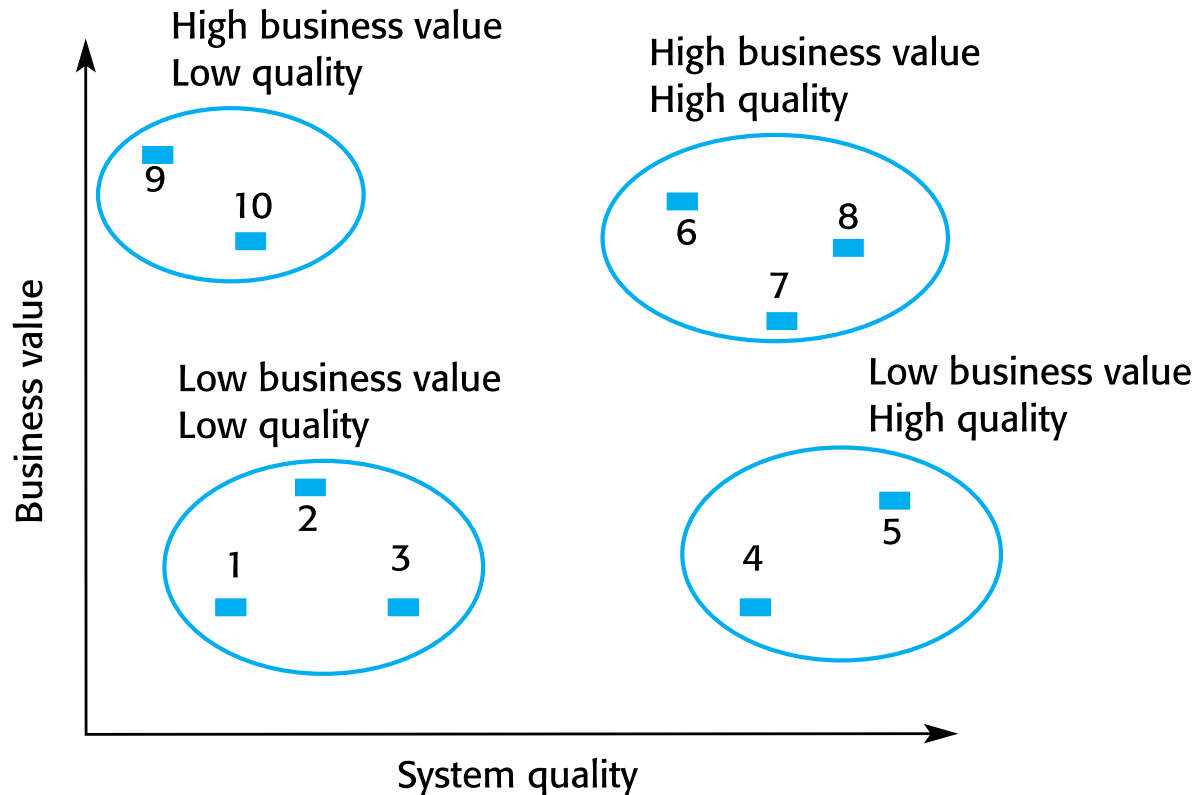
Legacy system change

- Legacy systems are **expensive to change** for a number of reasons:
 - **No** consistent programming **style**
 - Use of **obsolete programming languages** with few people available with these language skills
 - **Inadequate** system **documentation**
 - System structure **degradation**
 - Program optimizations may make them **hard to understand**
 - Data **errors, duplication** and **inconsistency**

Legacy system management

- Organisations that rely on legacy systems must choose a **strategy for evolving** these systems
 - **Scrap** the system completely and **modify** business processes so that it is no longer required;
 - **Continue maintaining** the system;
 - **Transform the system** by **re-engineering** to improve its maintainability;
 - **Replace** the system with a **new system**.
- The strategy chosen should depend on the system quality and its business value.

Figure 9.13 An example of a legacy system assessment



Legacy system categories

- Low quality, low business value
 - These systems should be **scrapped**.
- Low-quality, high-business value
 - These make an important business contribution but are expensive to maintain. Should be **re-engineered or replaced** if a suitable system is available.
- High-quality, low-business value
 - Replace with **COTS** (commercial off-the-shelf), **scrap completely or maintain**.
- High-quality, high business value
 - **Continue** in operation using **normal system maintenance**.

Business value assessment

- Assessment should take **different viewpoints** into account
 - ☐ System end-users;
 - ☐ Business customers;
 - ☐ Line managers;
 - ☐ IT managers;
 - ☐ Senior managers.
- Interview different stakeholders and collate results.

Issues in business value assessment

- The **use** of the system
 - If systems are only used **occasionally** or by a **small number of people**, they may have a **low** business value.
- The business **processes** that are supported
 - A system may have a **low** business value if it forces the use of **inefficient business processes**.
- System **dependability**
 - If a system is **not dependable** and the problems **directly affect** business **customers**, the system has a **low** business value.
- The system **outputs**
 - If the business **depends on system outputs**, then the system has a **high** business value.

System quality assessment

■ Business process assessment

- ☐ How well does the business process **support** the current **goals** of the business?

■ Environment assessment

- ☐ How **effective** is the system's environment and how **expensive** is it to maintain?

■ Application assessment

- ☐ What is the **quality** of the application software system?

Business process assessment

- Use a viewpoint-oriented approach and seek answers from system stakeholders
 - ☐ Is there a defined **process model** and is it followed?
 - ☐ Do different parts of the organisation use **different processes** for the **same function**?
 - ☐ How has the **process** been **adapted**?
 - ☐ What are the **relationships** with **other business processes** and are these necessary?
 - ☐ Is the process effectively **supported** by the **legacy** application software?
- Example - a travel ordering system may have a low business value because of the widespread use of web-based ordering.

Factors used in environment assessment

Factor	Questions
Supplier stability	Is the supplier still in existence? Is the supplier financially stable and likely to continue in existence? If the supplier is no longer in business, does someone else maintain the systems?
Failure rate	Does the hardware have a high rate of reported failures? Does the support software crash and force system restarts?
Age	How old is the hardware and software? The older the hardware and support software, the more obsolete it will be. It may still function correctly but there could be significant economic and business benefits to moving to a more modern system.
Performance	Is the performance of the system adequate? Do performance problems have a significant effect on system users?

Factors used in environment assessment

Factor	Questions
Support requirements	What local support is required by the hardware and software? If there are high costs associated with this support, it may be worth considering system replacement.
Maintenance costs	What are the costs of hardware maintenance and support software licenses? Older hardware may have higher maintenance costs than modern systems. Support software may have high annual licensing costs.
Interoperability	Are there problems interfacing the system to other systems? Can compilers, for example, be used with current versions of the operating system? Is hardware emulation required?

Factors used in application assessment

Factor	Questions
Understandability	How difficult is it to understand the source code of the current system? How complex are the control structures that are used? Do variables have meaningful names that reflect their function?
Documentation	What system documentation is available? Is the documentation complete, consistent, and current?
Data	Is there an explicit data model for the system? To what extent is data duplicated across files? Is the data used by the system up to date and consistent?
Performance	Is the performance of the application adequate? Do performance problems have a significant effect on system users?

Factors used in application assessment

Factor	Questions
Programming language	Are modern compilers available for the programming language used to develop the system? Is the programming language still used for new system development?
Configuration management	Are all versions of all parts of the system managed by a configuration management system? Is there an explicit description of the versions of components that are used in the current system?
Test data	Does test data for the system exist? Is there a record of regression tests carried out when new features have been added to the system?
Personnel skills	Are there people available who have the skills to maintain the application? Are there people available who have experience with the system?

System measurement

- You may collect **quantitative data** to make an **assessment** of the quality of the application system
 - The number of **system change requests**; The **higher** this accumulated value, the **lower** the quality of the system.
 - The number of **different user interfaces** used by the system; The **more** interfaces, the more likely it is that there will be **inconsistencies** and **redundancies** in these interfaces.
 - The **volume of data** used by the system. As the volume of data (number of files, size of database, etc.) processed by the system **increases**, so too do the **inconsistencies** and **errors** in that data.
 - **Cleaning up old data** is a very expensive and time-consuming process



Software maintenance

Software maintenance

- Modifying a program after it has been put into use.
- The term is mostly used for changing **custom software**. **Generic software** products are said to **evolve** to create new versions.
- Maintenance does not normally involve major **changes** to the system's **architecture**.
- Changes are implemented by **modifying** existing components and **adding new** components to the system.

Types of maintenance (ISO/IEC 14764:2006)

- **Corrective** maintenance: Reactive modification of a software product performed after delivery to correct discovered problems;
- **Adaptive** maintenance: Modification of a software product performed after delivery to keep a software product usable in a changed or changing environment;
- **Perfective** maintenance: Modification of a software product after delivery to improve performance or maintainability;
- **Preventive** maintenance: Modification of a software product after delivery to detect and correct latent faults in the software product before they become effective faults.



Distribution of Maintenance Effort

- Corrective (approx. 21%)
 - 12.4% emergency debugging
 - 9.3% routine debugging
- Adaptive (approx. 25%)
 - 17.3% data environment adaptation
 - 6.2% changes to hardware or operating system
- Perfective (approx. 50%)
 - 41.8% enhancements for users
 - 5.5% improve documentation
 - 3.4% other
- Preventive (approx. 4%)
 - 4.0% improve code efficiency

Types of maintenance

- Fault **repairs**

- Changing a system to fix bugs/vulnerabilities and correct deficiencies in the way meets its requirements.

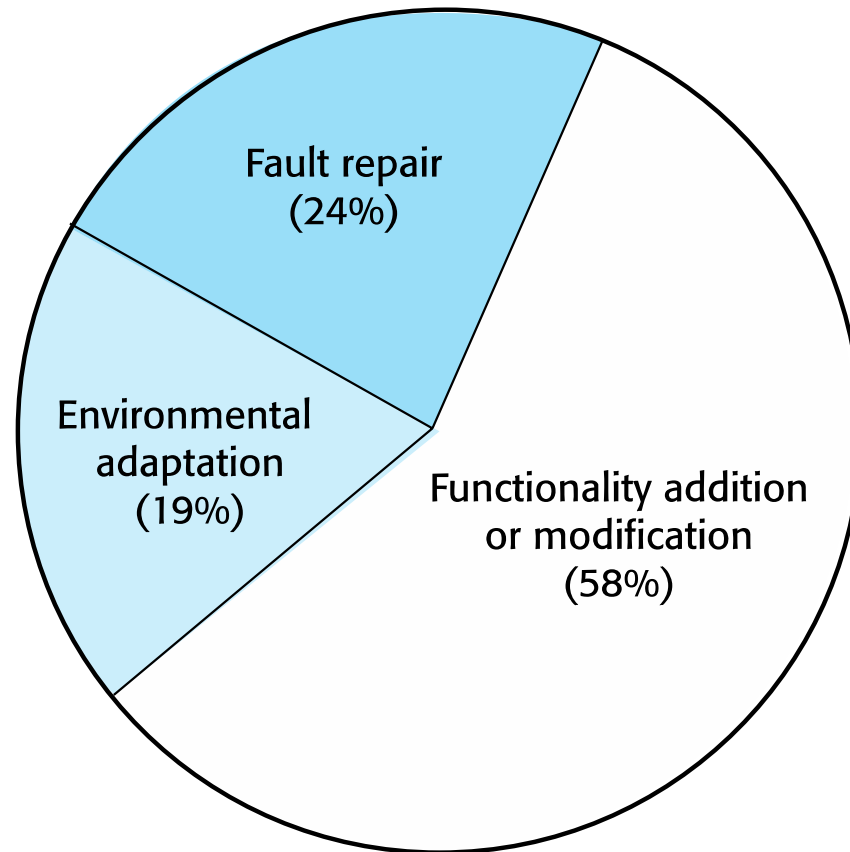
- Environmental **adaptation**

- Maintenance to adapt software to a different operating environment
 - Changing a system so that it operates in a different environment (computer, OS, etc.) from its initial implementation.

- Functionality **addition** and **modification**

- Modifying the system to satisfy new requirements.

Maintenance effort distribution



Maintenance costs

- Usually greater than development costs (2* to 100* depending on the application).
- Affected by both technical and non-technical factors.
- Increases as software is maintained.
Maintenance corrupts the software structure so makes further maintenance more difficult.
- Ageing software can have high support costs (e.g. old languages, compilers etc.).

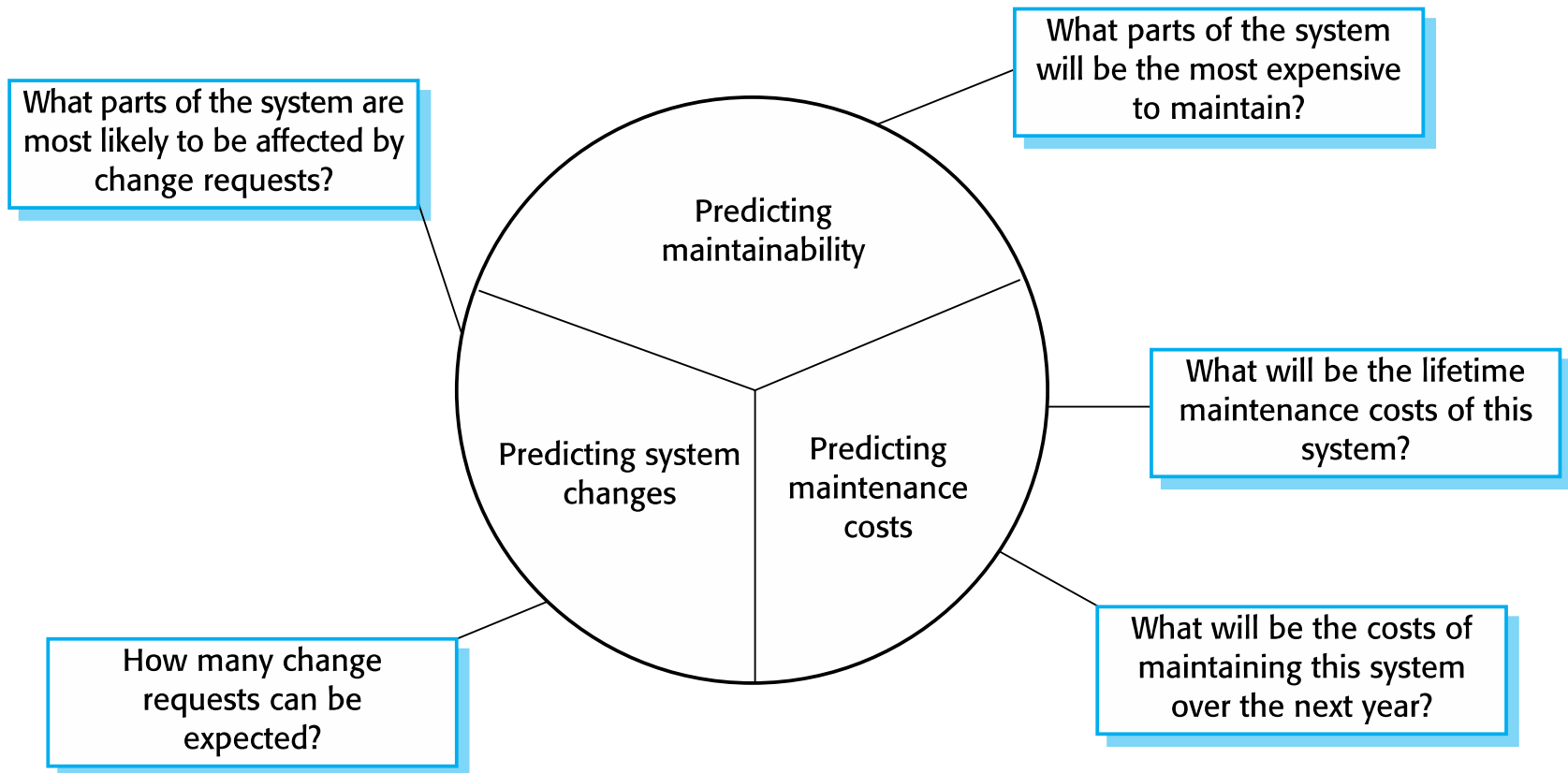
Maintenance costs

- It is usually **more expensive** to add **new features** to a system during **maintenance** than it is to add the same features during **development**
 - A new team has to understand the programs being maintained
 - Separating maintenance and development means there is no incentive for the development team to write maintainable software
 - Program maintenance work is unpopular
 - Maintenance staff are often inexperienced and have limited domain knowledge.
 - As programs age, their structure degrades and they become harder to change

Maintenance prediction

- Maintenance prediction is concerned with **assessing** which **parts** of the system **may cause problems** and have high maintenance costs
 - Change acceptance depends on the maintainability of the components affected by the change;
 - Implementing changes **degrades** the system and reduces its maintainability;
 - Maintenance costs depend on the **number of changes** and **costs** of change depend on **maintainability**.

Maintenance prediction



Change prediction

- Predicting the number of changes requires an understanding of the relationships between a system and its environment.
- Tightly coupled systems require changes whenever the environment is changed.
- Factors influencing this relationship are:
 - Number and complexity of system interfaces;
 - Number of inherently volatile system requirements;
 - The business processes where the system is used.

Complexity metrics

- Predictions of maintainability can be made by assessing the complexity of system components.
- Studies have shown that most maintenance effort is spent on a relatively small number of system components.
- Complexity depends on
 - Complexity of control structures;
 - Complexity of data structures;
 - Object, method (procedure) and module size.

Process metrics

- Process metrics may be used to assess maintainability
 - Number of requests for **corrective** maintenance;
 - Average **time** required for **impact analysis**;
 - Average **time** taken to **implement a change request**;
 - Number of **outstanding** change requests.
- If any or all of these is increasing, this may indicate a **decline** in maintainability.

Software reengineering

- **Restructuring or rewriting** part or all of a legacy system **without changing its functionality.**
- Applicable where some but not all **sub-systems** of a larger system **require frequent maintenance.**
- Reengineering involves adding effort to make them **easier to maintain.** The system may be **re-structured and re-documented.**

Advantages of reengineering

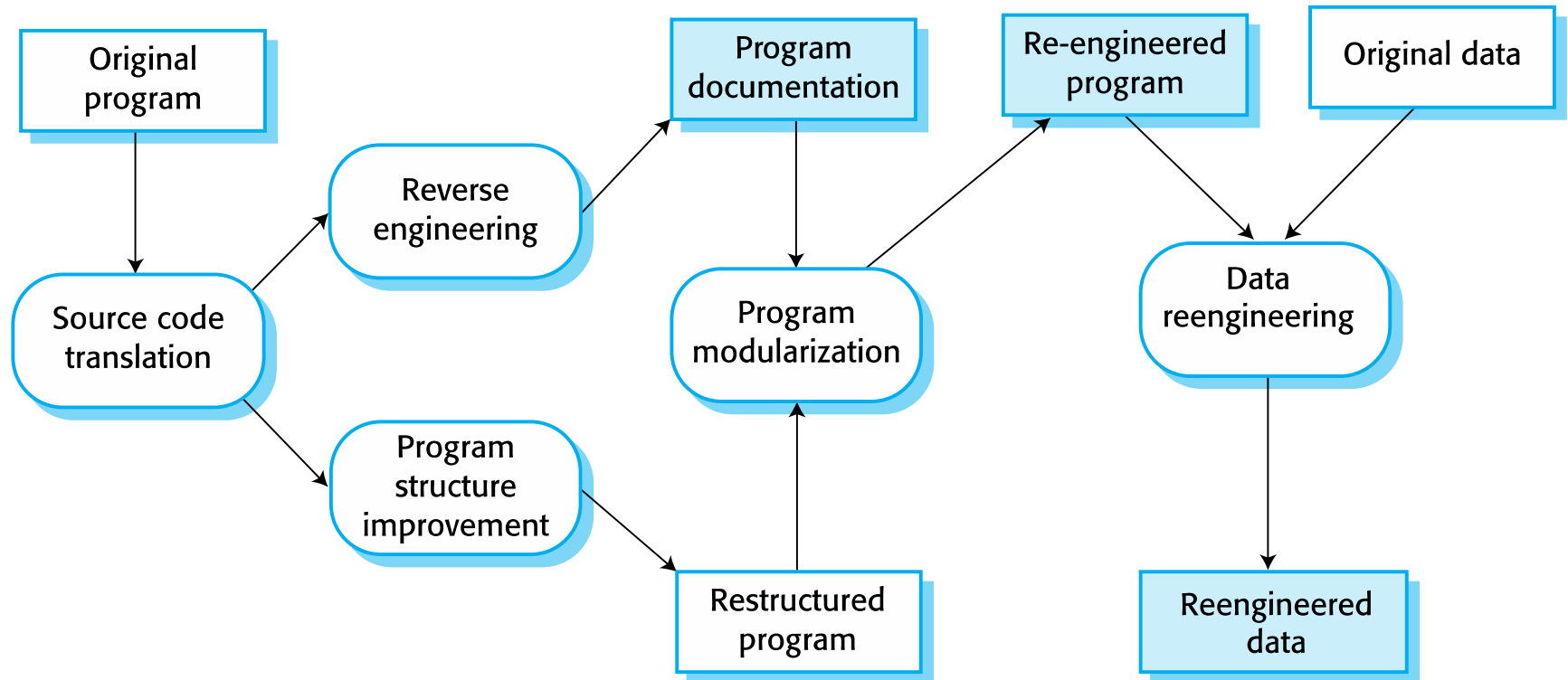
■ Reduced risk

- There is a **high risk** in new software development.
There may be development problems, staffing problems and specification problems.

■ Reduced cost

- The **cost of re-engineering** is often **significantly less** than the costs of developing new software.

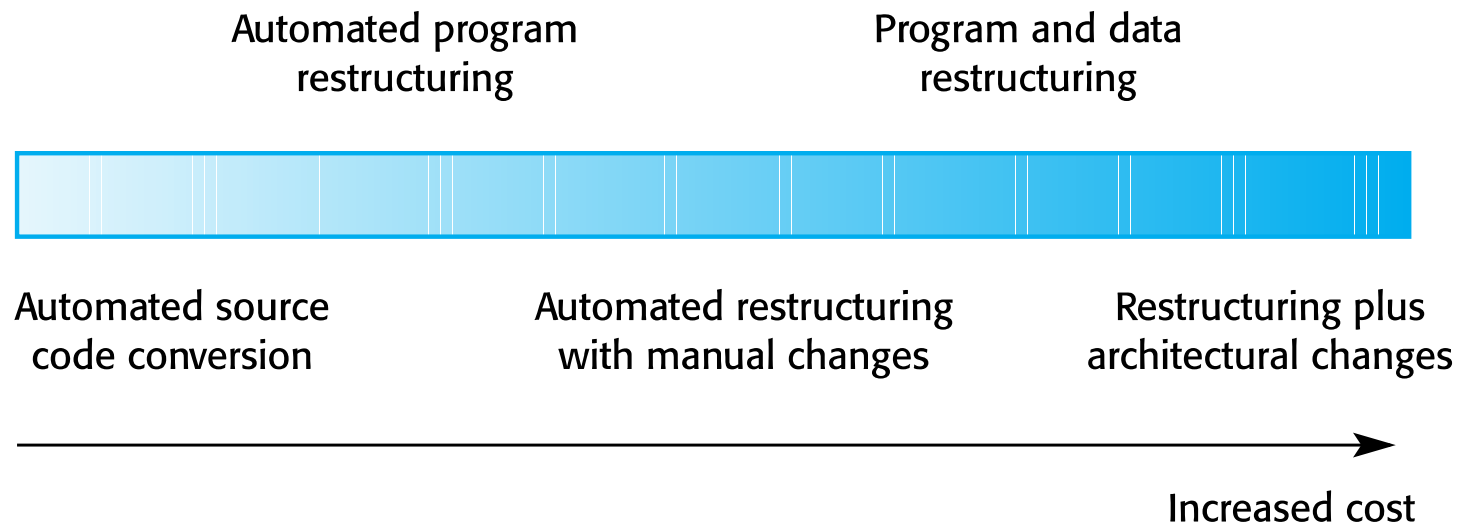
The reengineering process



Reengineering process activities

- Source code translation
 - Convert code to a new language.
- Reverse engineering
 - Analyze the program to understand it;
- Program structure improvement
 - Restructure automatically for understandability;
- Program modularization
 - Reorganize the program structure;
- Data reengineering
 - Clean-up and restructure system data.

Reengineering approaches



Reengineering cost factors

- The **quality** of the software to be reengineered.
- The **tool support** available for reengineering.
- The extent of the **data conversion** which is required.
- The availability of **expert staff** for reengineering.
 - This can be a problem with old systems based on technology that is no longer widely used.

Refactoring

- Refactoring is the process of making **improvements** to a program to slow down degradation through change.
- You can think of refactoring as '**preventative maintenance**' that reduces the problems of future change.
- Refactoring involves **modifying a program** to improve its structure, reduce its complexity or make it easier to understand.
- When you refactor a program, you should not add functionality but rather **concentrate on program improvement**.

Refactoring and reengineering

- Reengineering takes place after a system has been maintained for some time and maintenance costs are increasing. You use **automated tools** to process and **reengineer** a legacy system to create a new system that is **more maintainable**.
- Refactoring is a continuous **process of improvement** throughout the development and evolution process. It is intended to **avoid** the structure and code **degradation** that increases the costs and difficulties of maintaining a system.

‘Bad smells’ in program code

■ Duplicate code

- The same or very similar code may be included at different places in a program. This can be removed and implemented as a single method or function that is called as required.

■ Long methods

- If a method is too long, it should be redesigned as a number of shorter methods.

■ Switch (case) statements

- These often involve duplication, where the switch depends on the type of a value. The switch statements may be scattered around a program. In object-oriented languages, you can often use polymorphism to achieve the same thing.

‘Bad smells’ in program code

■ Data clumping

- Data clumps occur when the same group of data items (fields in classes, parameters in methods) re-occur in several places in a program. These can often be replaced with an object that encapsulates all of the data.

■ Speculative generality

- This occurs when developers include generality in a program in case it is required in the future. This can often simply be removed.

Key points

- Software development and evolution can be thought of as an integrated, iterative process that can be represented using a spiral model.
- For custom systems, the costs of software maintenance usually exceed the software development costs.
- The process of software evolution is driven by requests for changes and includes change impact analysis, release planning and change implementation.
- Legacy systems are older software systems, developed using obsolete software and hardware technologies, that remain useful for a business.

Key points

- It is often cheaper and less risky to maintain a legacy system than to develop a replacement system using modern technology.
- The business value of a legacy system and the quality of the application should be assessed to help decide if a system should be replaced, transformed or maintained.
- There are 3 types of software maintenance, namely bug fixing, modifying software to work in a new environment, and implementing new or changed requirements.

Key points

- Software reengineering is concerned with restructuring and re-documenting software to make it easier to understand and change.
- Refactoring, making program changes that preserve functionality, is a form of preventative maintenance.